hw2-numbers

CSE020F26

Due: 10/20/26 at 5pm (no penalty late submission until 8am next morning)

In this assignment,

You will practice applying functions and tracing algorithms in multiple contexts, and exploring properties of positional number representations.

Relevant class material: Week 2 and Week 3.

You will submit this assignment via Gradescope (https://www.gradescope.com) in the assignment called "hw2-numbers".

For all HW assignments: These homework assignments must be done in groups of three students. Please ensure your name(s) and TSN(s) are clearly visible on the first page of your homework submission, start each question on a new page, and upload the PDF to Gradescope. If you're working in a group, *submit only one submission per group*: one partner uploads the submission through their Gradescope account and then adds the other group members to the Gradescope submission by selecting their name(s) in the "Add Group Members" dialog box. You will need to re-add your group member(s) every time you resubmit a new version of your assignment.

All submitted homework for this class must be typed. You can use a word processing editor if you like (Microsoft Word, Open Office, Notepad, Vim, Google Docs, etc.) but you might find it useful to take this opportunity to learn LaTeX. LaTeX is a markup language used widely in computer science and mathematics. The homework assignments are typed using LaTeX and you can use the source files as templates for typesetting your solutions.

After you submit the PDF of the homework, you will meet with a TA for a Homework Q&A session. This session is a primary component of your homework score. All group members must be present and able to fully participate in discussions of each question.

Integrity reminders

- Problems should be solved together, not divided up between the partners. The homework

Copyright Mia Minnes, 2026, Version October 20, 2026 (1)

is designed to give you practice with the main concepts and techniques of the course, while getting to know and learn from your classmates.

- Use only resources explicitly allowed for each assignment. Resources not affiliated with this quarter's version of the class may use inconsistent notation or definitions. When consulting resources, balance getting the help you need while also protecting the learning experience you will have when the 'aha' moments of solving the problem authentically happen.
- Do not share written solutions or partial solutions for homework with other students in the class who are not in your group. Doing so would dilute their learning experience and detract from their success in the class.

When discussing your homework solutions, you should be prepared to describe

- The key ideas that establish the correctness of any final answers.
- What evidence demonstrates the soundness of your results and methods.
- What would need to change in the solution to solve a similar but different question.

A rule of thumb for the level of detail to include is to imagine someone who is taking the class alongside you but missed about a week's worth of content: does your writeup have enough detail for them to learn from it?

To demonstrate your honest effort in answering homework questions, we expect you to include your attempt to answer *each* part of the question. If you get stuck with your attempt, you can still demonstrate your effort by explaining where you got stuck and what you did to try to get unstuck (e.g. reviewing annotated notes from class, checking the relevant textbook sections, looking up comparable questions on the relevant weekly review quizzes, asking questions on Piazza, attending (instructor/TA/tutor) office hours, consulting generative AI tools, etc.).

Assigned questions

1. Functions and algorithms: in this question you'll explore the properties of the (integer) power and logarithm functions. We'll use some definitions we introduced in class and review quiz. In particular, recall the function

$$b^i$$

with domain $\mathbb{Z}^+ \times \mathbb{N}$ and codomain $\mathbb{N}$ defined recursively by

$$\text{Basis Step: } b^0 = 1$$
$$\text{Recursive Step: If } i \in \mathbb{N}, b^{i+1} = b \cdot b^i$$

Also, recall the algorithm *logb* given by the pseudocode below

Copyright Mia Minnes, 2026, Version October 20, 2026 (2)

Calculating integer part of base b logarithm

```
1    procedure logb(b,n: positive integers with b>1)
2    i := 0
3    while n > b-1
4      i := i+1
5      n := n div b
6    return i {i holds the integer part of the base b logarithm of n}
```

(a) Choose a positive integer b between 3 and 6 (inclusive) and choose a nonnegative integer i between 2 and 5 (inclusive). Demonstrate how to calculate the result of the *logb* algorithm (procedure) when its input is the base b you chose and $n = b^i$ (for the i you choose.) A complete answer will include the specific choice of b and i, along with trace of the calculations of b^i and the computation of the algorithm, including (clear, correct, complete) calculations for each of the function applications and/or references to definitions and a trace table for algorithm that includes the values of all relevant variables at each iteration (See the annotated Week 2 notes and the review quiz for the level of detail expected in a trace of a function application and a trace table).

(b) Now we'll go in the other direction: Demonstrate how to calculate the result of 7^y where y is the result of the *logb* algorithm (procedure) when its input is $b = 7$ and $n = 30$. A complete answer will include clearly labelled traces of the calculations of b^i and the computation of the algorithm, including (clear, correct, complete) calculations for each of the function applications and/or references to definitions and a trace table for algorithm that includes the values of all relevant variables at each iteration (See the annotated Week 2 notes for the level of detail expected in a trace of a function application and a trace table).

(c) Logarithms and powers are supposed to "undo" one another. Explain whether your work in parts (a) and (b) supports that idea, whether you saw anything confusing or surprising about these calculations, and how to explain what you saw.

2. Base expansions

(a) Pick an integer between 50 and 1000 (inclusive) that you (or one of your group members) came across at some point this week. In a sentence or two, give some context for why you're choosing this number). Write the base expansion of your chosen number in base 2 (binary), base 3 (ternary), base 4, and base 16 (hexadecimal).

(b) What is the **smallest** width w in which they could write your chosen number in base 8 (octal) fixed-width w? Justify your answer with reference to the definitions of fixed-width expansions and relevant calculations.

(c) Express in roster method the set of numbers between 1 and 2 (exclusive) that be written without error (full precision) in binary fixed width expansion with integer part width 3 and fractional part width 2. Justify your answer with reference to the definitions of fixed-width expansions and relevant calculations.

(d) Consider the strings of 1s that have length 3, 5, 7, and 10. Calculate the numbers

Copyright Mia Minnes, 2026, Version October 20, 2026 (3)

$[111]_{s,3}$	$[111]_{2c,3}$
$[11111]_{s,5}$	$[11111]_{2c,5}$
$[1111111]_{s,7}$	$[1111111]_{2c,7}$
$[1111111111]_{s,10}$	$[1111111111]_{2c,10}$

Justify your answers with specific reference to the definitions of sign-magnitude and 2s complement expansions and relevant calculations and discuss any patterns you notice.

3. Multiple representations

Recall that, mathematically, a color can be represented as a 3-tuple (r, g, b) where r represents the red component, g the green component, b the blue component and where each of r, g, b must be from the collection $\{x \in \mathbb{N} \mid 0 \leq x \leq 255\}$. As an alternative representation, in this assignment we'll use base b fixed-width expansions to represent colors as individual numbers (this definition was introduced in a recent Review quiz question).

Definition: A **hex color** is a nonnegative integer, n, that has a base 16 fixed-width 6 expansion

$$n = (r_1 r_2 g_1 g_2 b_1 b_2)_{16,6}$$

where $(r_1 r_2)_{16,2}$ is the red component, $(g_1 g_2)_{16,2}$ is the green component, and $(b_1 b_2)_{16,2}$ is the blue.

For this question, let's call the set of hex colors HC. In the Week 2 Review quiz, we explored a few different set builder definitions for HC.

(a) Rewrite the set builder definition of a set below so that it refers to colors rather than numbers: $\{c \in HC \mid c \mod 256 = 0\}$. A complete answer will justify the new set builder definition by connection with the definition of hex colors and how it impacts the colors that satisfy the specific property for this set.

(b) Rewrite the set builder definition of a set below so that it refers to colors rather than numbers: $\{c \in HC \mid c < 65536\}$. A complete answer will justify the new set builder definition by connection with the definition of hex colors and how it impacts the colors that satisfy the specific property for this set.

(c) In art, we can mix two colors to get a new color. For example, red and blue make purple, blue and yellow make green, red and yellow make orange. A mathematical definition of **hex color mixing** would be a function with domain $HC \times HC$ and codomain HC where the result of applying this function to an input (n_1, n_2) is the hex color that results from mixing the hex colors n_1 and n_2.

Sample work for a related question that can be used as reference for the detail expected in your answer: Consider the attempted mathematical definition $f_1 : HC \times HC \to HC$ given by

$$f_1(\ (n_1, n_2)\ ) = n_1 + n_2$$

Copyright Mia Minnes, 2026, Version October 20, 2026 (4)

We will show that this function is not well-defined so it cannot give a hex color mixing definition. The reason it is not well-defined is that the application of the rule sometimes gives values that are not in the stated codomain. To see this, we need an example input to f_1 for which the output of the rule is not in HC. Here is one such example: $(n_1, n_2) = (\ (FFFFFF)_{16,6}, (FFFFFF)_{16,6}\ )$. This example is in $HC \times HC$ because $(FFFFFF)_{16,6}$ is a nonnegative integer that has a base 16 fixed-width 6 expansion so it is a hex color. We now apply the definition of the rule in f_1:

$$\begin{aligned} f_1(\ (n_1, n_2)\ ) &= f_1((\ (FFFFFF)_{16,6}, (FFFFFF)_{16,6}\ )) = (FFFFFF)_{16,6} + (FFFFFF)_{16,6} \\ &= 2\left(15 \cdot 16^5 + 15 \cdot 16^4 + 15 \cdot 16^3 + 15 \cdot 16^2 + 15 \cdot 16^1 + 15 \cdot 16^0\right) \\ &= 2 \cdot 15 \cdot (1048576 + 65536 + 4096 + 256 + 16 + 1) = 2 \cdot 15 \cdot 1118481 = 33554430 \end{aligned}$$

This is not a hex color because it is greater than or equal to $16^6 = 16777216$, so (using the Week 2 notes on which numbers can be represented with fixed-width expansions) it does not have a hexadecimal **fixed width** 6 expansion.

In this question, we'll look at another attempted mathematical definition for hex color mixing. We define $f_2 : HC \times HC \to HC$ given by

$$f_2(\ (n_1, n_2)\ ) = (n_1 + n_2) \textbf{ div } 2$$

This is a well-defined function. You do not need to prove this or hand it in, but it's good practice to make sure you understand why it's well-defined. Notice that the function application

$$f_2(\ (\ (FF0000)_{16,6}, (FFFE00)_{16,6}\ )\ )$$

can be calculated as:

$$\begin{aligned} f_2(((FF0000)_{16,6}, (FFFE00)_{16,6})) &= ((FF0000)_{16,6} + (FFFE00)_{16,6})) \textbf{ div } 2 \\ &= \Big(\ \left(15 \cdot 16^5 + 15 \cdot 16^4 + 0 \cdot 16^3 + 0 \cdot 16^2 + 0 \cdot 16^1 + 0 \cdot 16^0\right) \\ &\quad + \ \left((15 \cdot 16^5 + 15 \cdot 16^4 + 15 \cdot 16^3 + 14 \cdot 16^2 + 0 \cdot 16^1 + 0 \cdot 16^0\right)\ \Big) \textbf{ div } 2 \\ &= (16711680 + 16776704) \textbf{ div } 2 = 33488384 \textbf{ div } 2 = 16744192 \end{aligned}$$

Since this is less than $16^6 = 16777216$, we can represent it using base 16 fixed-width 6:.

$$(16744192)_{10} = 15 \cdot 16^5 + 15 \cdot 16^4 + 7 \cdot 16^3 + 15 \cdot 16^2 + 0 \cdot 16^1 + 0 \cdot 16^0 = (FF7F00)_{16,6}$$

Using the web tool `https://www.w3schools.com/colors/colors_rgb.asp`, we can verify that $(FF0000)_{16,6}$ is red, $(FFFE00)_{16,6}$ is yellow, and $(FF7F00)_{16,6}$ is orange.

Show that f_2 does not work as a hex color mixing definition by finding another ordered pair of hex colors for which the result of applying f_2 does not give the expected hex color. Include the numerical description of each colors you mention, alongside a description of them in English. Describe how you know what these colors are (if you use a web color tool, include its URL in your submission writeup; if not, describe your reasoning). Justify your example with (clear, correct, complete) calculations and/or references to definitions, and connecting them with the desired conclusion.

Copyright Mia Minnes, 2026, Version October 20, 2026 (5)

4. Fixed-width addition.

   (a) Choose example width 5 first summand and width 5 second summand so that in the binary fixed-width addition (adding one bit at time, using the usual column-by-column and carry arithmetic, and ignoring the carry from the leftmost column), the example satisfies all three conditions below simultaneously

      (1) When interpreting each of the summands and the result in binary fixed-width 5, the result represents the actual value of the sum of the summands **and**

      (2) when interpreting each of the summands and the sum in sign-magnitude width 5, the result represents the actual value of the sum of the summands **and**

      (3) when interpreting each of the summands and the sum in 2s complement width 5, the result represents the actual value of the sum of the summands.

   (b) Choose an example width 5 first summand and second summand so that in the binary fixed-width addition (adding one bit at time, using the usual column-by-column and carry arithmetic, and ignoring the carry from the leftmost column), the example satisfies all three conditions below simultaneously

      (1) When interpreting each of the summands and the result in binary fixed-width 5, the result **does not** represent the actual value of the sum of the summands **and**

      (2) when interpreting each of the summands and the sum in sign-magnitude width 5, the result **does not** represents the actual value of the sum of the summands **and**

      (3) when interpreting each of the summands and the sum in 2s complement width 5, the result represents the actual value of the sum of the summands.

      A complete solution will clearly specify each summand and the result of binary fixed-width addition with this choice of summands; will specify the value of each summand and the result for binary fixed-width 5, sign-magnitude width 5, and 2s complement width 5 (and include calculations connecting with the definitions of these representations to explain these values); and a conclusion connecting the calculations to the properties laid out in the question.

Copyright Mia Minnes, 2026, Version October 20, 2026 (6)